

STEPHEN ANDREW STAKER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineering Manager with 12+ years of experience building and scaling high-availability backend systems, event-driven architectures, and cloud-based platforms in regulated healthcare and benefits administration environments. Proven record leading 30+ engineers across multiple product domains, modernizing legacy batch pipelines into real-time Kafka-based architectures, and driving API-first system design. Leverages AI-augmented development workflows using Claude Code agentic orchestration to accelerate delivery of compliant, production-grade software. Combines deep hands-on technical ownership with team scaling, cross-functional delivery management, and a strong focus on data integrity, system reliability, and regulatory compliance.

SKILLS

Leadership: Engineering Team Scaling, Technical Mentorship, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Delivery Risk Management, Platform Ownership, Agile Project Management, Stakeholder Communication, Hiring and Onboarding

Backend and Systems: Backend Service Design, Event-Driven Architecture (Kafka, RabbitMQ), API-First System Design (REST, GraphQL), Data Pipelines and ETL, System Reliability and Observability, Legacy System Modernization, Microservices, Domain-Driven Design

AI and Automation: Claude Code, AI-Augmented Development, Agentic Workflows (PO/Dev/QA Agent Orchestration), Prompt Engineering, AI-Assisted Code Review

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, PHP, Python (FastAPI, Celery), C#, .NET, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Flutter, Dart, Kafka, Redis, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Docker, Docker Compose, Git, Splunk, Opsgenie, Jira, Confluence, Figma

Domain Expertise: Healthcare Compliance, Benefits Administration, ACA Reporting, COBRA, Insurance Carrier Integration, EDI, LIMRA LDEX / BEM Data Standards, Direct Primary Care (DPC), Enrollment and Coverage Data Exchange

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Manager of Software Development (Engineering Manager) 2023 – Present

Paycom – Oklahoma City, OK

- Lead 30+ software engineers and 16 QA analysts across three regulated product domains: ACA compliance, Benefits Administration, and COBRA, supporting millions of end users.
- Built and scaled three cross-functional backend engineering teams in parallel, growing each from early-stage groups into mature delivery organizations with structured hiring, onboarding, and mentorship programs.
- Own execution of a 20+ project engineering portfolio spanning backend services, real-time data pipelines, system modernization, and operational stability initiatives.
- Serve as engineering owner for a strategic real-time insurance carrier integration platform, replacing legacy batch-based EDI file exchanges with standardized REST APIs to reduce data latency and improve partner onboarding velocity.
- Oversee implementation of industry-standard LIMRA LDEX / BEM data models, ensuring consistent and compliant exchange of enrollment and coverage data across carrier partners.
- Architect and govern Kafka-based event-driven systems enabling near real-time data transmission, downstream processing, and improved system observability.
- Provide architectural oversight for backend service design, API contracts, and data flow patterns across product lines, ensuring scalability and domain isolation.
- Own delivery risk and system reliability, balancing throughput, correctness, and observability across high-volume, compliance-critical workflows.

Technical Lead2018 – 2023

Paycom – Oklahoma City, OK

- Served as technical owner for mission-critical backend systems supporting authentication, compliance, financial workflows, and high-volume transactional processing.
- Designed and implemented backend services powering React-based frontends used by millions of users, focusing on API contract clarity and service reliability.
- Led modernization initiatives migrating monolithic applications into API-first service architectures, reducing deployment coupling and improving release velocity.
- Built complex multi-tenant data workflows across employee, client, and administrative systems, ensuring data correctness and tenant isolation.
- Operated consistently in high-risk problem spaces involving data integrity, performance bottlenecks, and system reliability under strict compliance requirements.

Team Leader, Benefits Administration Platform2015 – 2018

Paycom – Oklahoma City, OK

- Founded a new backend-focused product team and scaled it to 8 engineers, establishing hiring processes and technical standards from the ground up.
- Re-architected enrollment and reporting systems into scalable, automated backend services, reducing manual intervention and improving regulatory data accuracy.
- Designed batch processing pipelines and nightly jobs supporting regulatory data generation and compliance workflows for ACA and benefits reporting.
- Established engineering and QA practices emphasizing correctness, traceability, and operational stability across the benefits domain.

Software Developer (Engineer)2013 – 2015

Paycom – Oklahoma City, OK

- Developed backend systems supporting reporting, organizational data, and core application workflows across the Paycom platform.
- Identified as a high-potential engineer and placed on complex, high-impact technical projects early in tenure, demonstrating rapid growth and technical depth.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS AND AI-AUGMENTED DEVELOPMENT

Agentic Software Development Workflow (Private Repositories) | *Claude Code, AI Agent Orchestration, Python, Kafka*

- Designed and operates a multi-agent AI development workflow using Claude Code with specialized PO (Product Owner), Dev, and QA agents to build production-grade medical Direct Primary Care (DPC) and benefits administration software.
- Orchestrates agentic pipelines where PO agents decompose requirements, Dev agents generate compliant code, and QA agents validate correctness, accelerating feature delivery while maintaining regulatory compliance standards.
- Applies AI-augmented development practices to event-driven, healthcare-compliant systems, demonstrating practical expertise in prompt engineering and agentic workflow design at the intersection of AI and regulated software.

java-spring-kafka-react | *Java 17, Spring Boot, Kafka (Redpanda), PostgreSQL, React, TypeScript, Docker*

- Built a full-stack event-driven demo application featuring REST API message creation, Kafka event publishing and consumer processing, PostgreSQL persistence, and idempotency-key support for safe retries.
- Implemented a React + TypeScript frontend with TanStack Query for server-state caching and invalidation, with clean API layer separation. Fully containerized via Docker Compose.

allhealth-hello | *Python, FastAPI, Celery, Redis, Docker*

- Developed a FastAPI-based microservice with asynchronous task processing via Celery and Redis, containerized with Docker Compose for local development and deployment readiness.

andrewstaker.com | *Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Vercel*

- Built and deployed a personal portfolio website using Next.js with server-side rendering, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS, hosted on Vercel with continuous deployment.

claude-string-tuner | *Flutter, Dart, C++, Cross-Platform (iOS, Android, Web, Desktop)*

- Developed a cross-platform string instrument tuner application using Flutter, with native platform integration across iOS, Android, Linux, macOS, Windows, and Web, built using Claude Code for AI-assisted development.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

University of Central Oklahoma

- Academic Performance Award (2014)
- Research Assistant: Neural Network Mobility Analytics – Built cloud-based mobile web application using neural-network modeling for mobility data analysis.

EARLIER TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

IT Support Technician2012 – 2013

Redlands Community College – El Reno, OK

- Maintained enterprise systems using Active Directory and SCCM for campus-wide IT infrastructure.

Research Assistant / Cloud Application Developer2012 – 2013

University of Central Oklahoma – Edmond, OK

- Built cloud-based mobile web application using neural-network modeling for mobility analytics research.